EASYCIRCULAR

User Manual

A short guide for people in schools who have to read Ministry of Education circulars

English · August 2026

Principals, teachers, office staff

Read the PDF | Check the text | Get a summary | Keep the original

Reading the pages

It pulls text out of ordinary PDFs and from scans, including Sinhala and Tamil.

A short brief

What the circular is about, who it is for, and a list of things the school has to do.

You check first

Nothing is summarised until you have looked at the extracted text. OCR gets names wrong.

Ministry list

You can import a file from moe.gov.lk instead of hunting for a copy in email.

Please read this

The summary is a shortcut, not the circular. If a date or a circular number looks wrong, open the PDF. If you imported from the catalog, the ministry page is still the official one.

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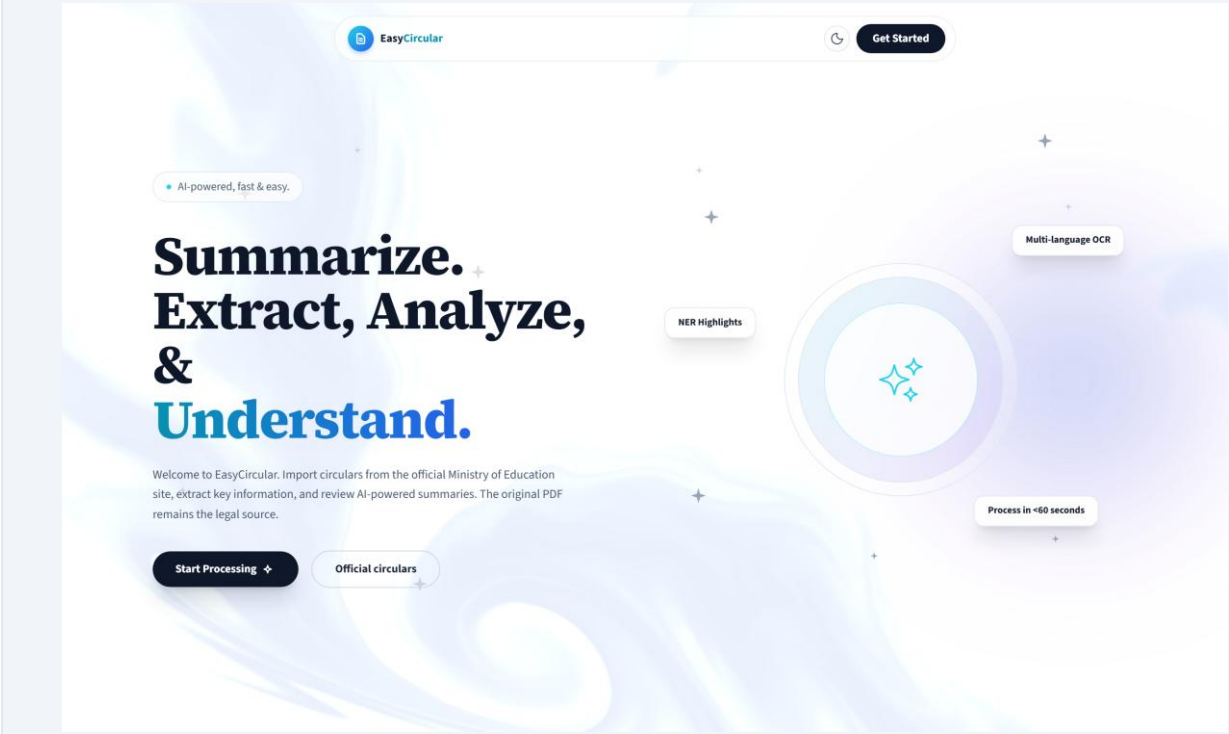
01 What this is

If you work in a school and you get MOE circulars as PDFs, this is for you. You either drop in a file you already have, or you pull one from the ministry site. The system reads the pages (including scans in English, Sinhala, or Tamil), shows you the text, and then writes a short brief.

You still have to look at that text before the summary runs. That is on purpose. OCR misreads names. Scans pick up stamps. Better you catch it than the summary invent a deadline.

After that you can copy the brief, download it as a PDF, or switch it to Sinhala or Tamil if the original was in English (and the other way round).

Figure 1 · Home. Start Processing if you have a file, Official circulars for the ministry list.



02 What you need

To run EasyCircular on a Windows PC you need the software below already installed. To use the website after it is running, Chrome, Edge, Firefox, or Safari is fine.

You need	Why
Windows	start.bat is written for a Windows PC
Node.js 20 or newer	Runs the website and the API
Python 3.11 or newer	Runs the AI service. Tick Add python.exe to PATH when you install it
MongoDB Community, or Docker Desktop	Stores the circulars. start.bat will try Docker if the MongoDB service is not there

Ollama (llama3.2:3b)	Local summaries. start.bat will try to install it with winget if it is missing
A browser	Chrome is fine. Open http://localhost:3002

You need an account: email and a password, or Google. The file has to be a real PDF, not bigger than 50 MB. You can look around without signing in. You cannot upload or import until you do.

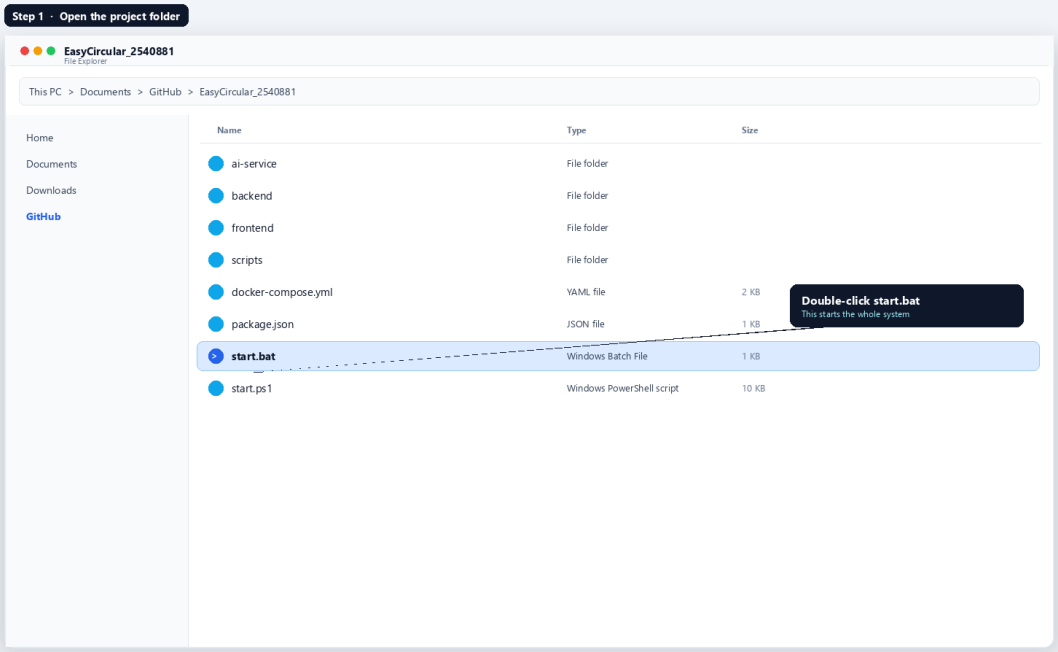
> **NOTE · Keep the original**
>
> EasyCircular does not replace the circular, and it does not send anything to the Ministry on your behalf. File the PDF with whatever summary you export.

03 How to start EasyCircular

Open the project folder. If you were given the assessment copy, that folder is named EasyCircular_2540881. Double-click start.bat. If you see Run-System.cmd instead, double-click that. It does the same job.

The first time can take several minutes. It installs Node packages, Python packages and the SpaCy model, and it may download the Ollama model. Later starts are quicker.

Figure 2 · Project folder. Double-click start.bat

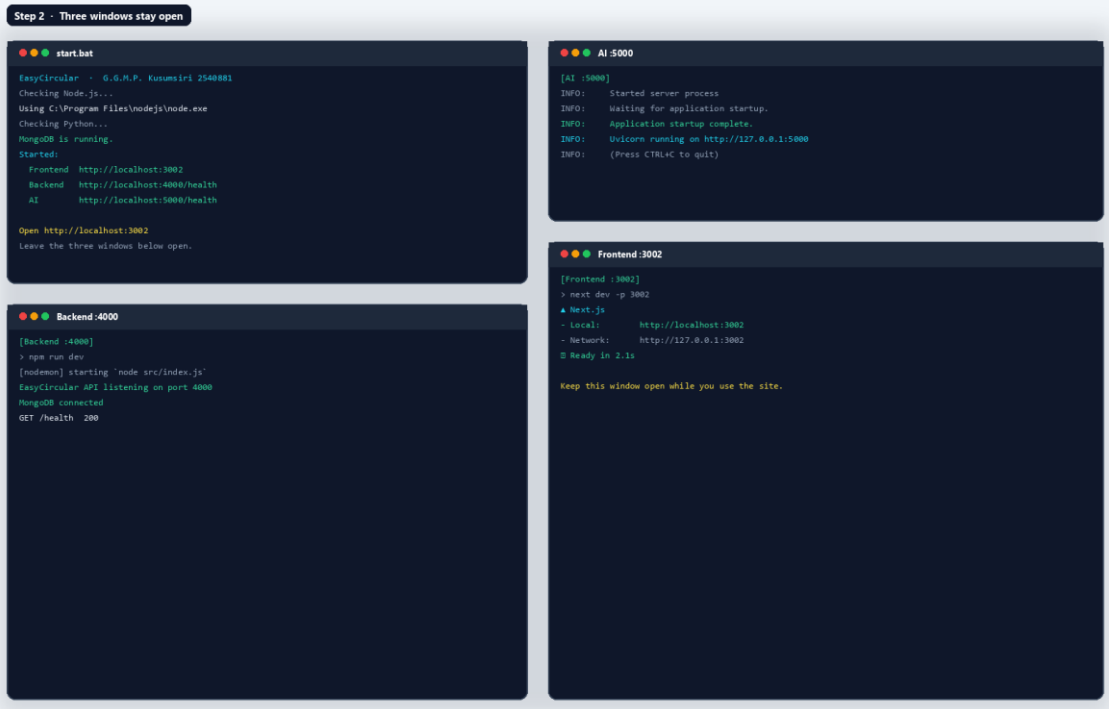


1	2	3	4
start.bat	**Wait**	**Browser**	**Status**
Double-click it in the project folder.	Three extra windows open and stay open.	Go to http://localhost:3002	Scroll to System Status. All should be healthy.

Three extra windows should stay open while you use the site:

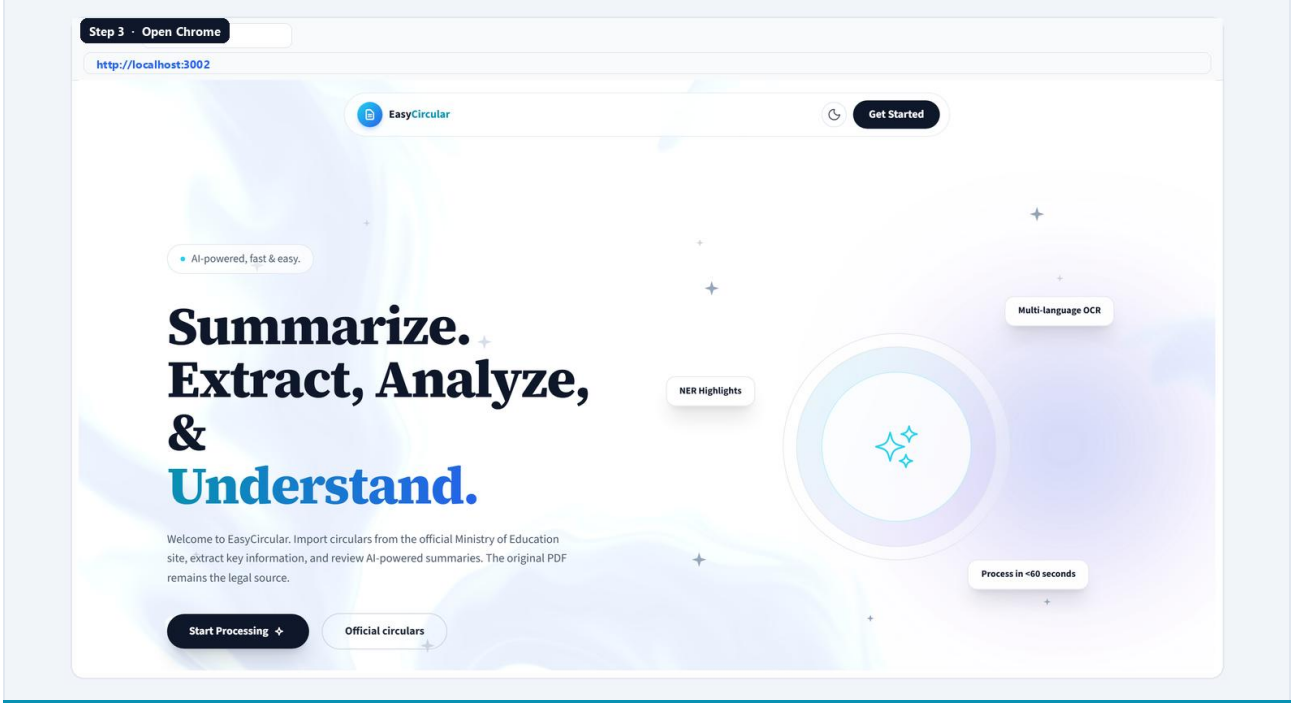
Window title	Port	What it is
AI :5000	5000	Reads PDFs and writes summaries
Backend :4000	4000	Accounts, uploads, library
Frontend :3002	3002	The website you open in Chrome

Figure 3 · After start.bat. Leave these windows open



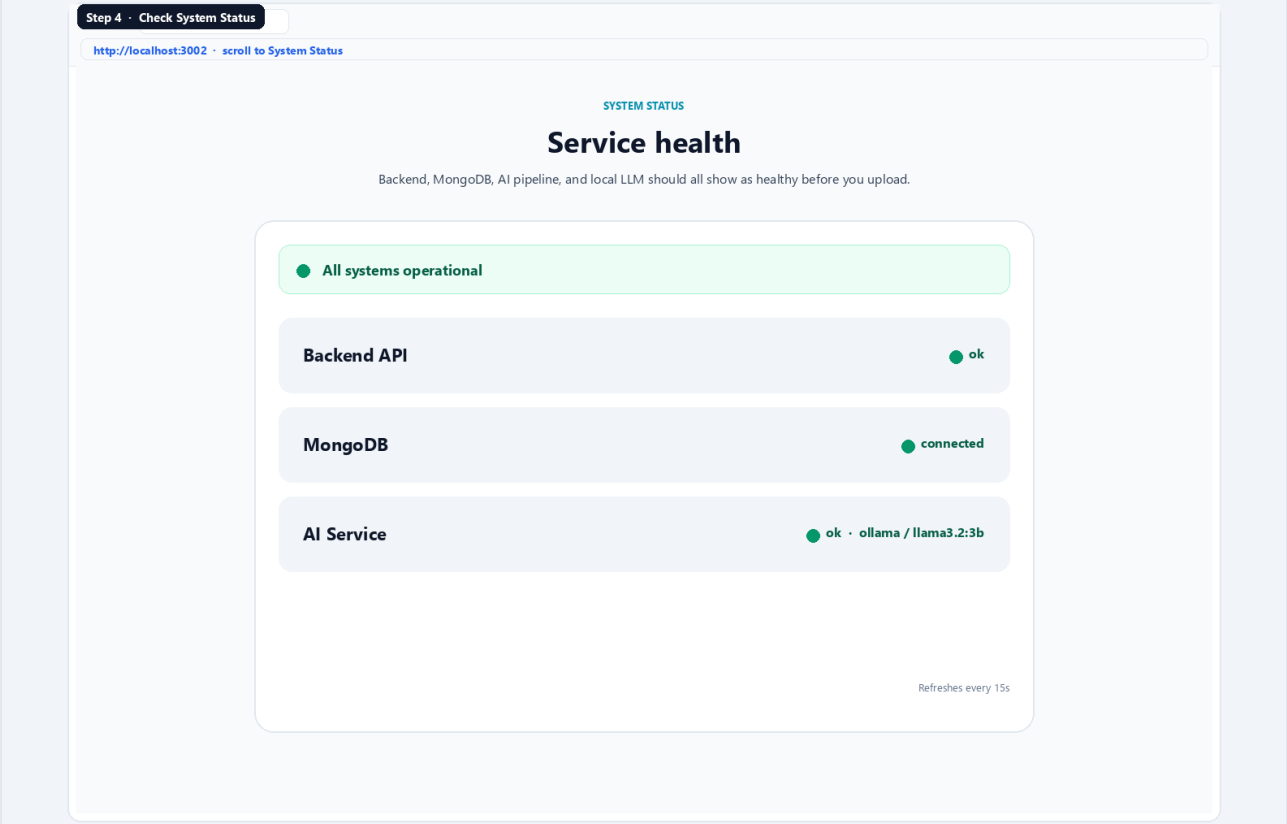
Open Chrome and type http://localhost:3002. Keep the three windows open while you work. Close them when you have finished.

Figure 4 · Chrome at http://localhost:3002



On the home page, scroll down to System Status. Backend, MongoDB and AI should show as healthy before you upload a circular. If AI is still unreachable, wait until the window titled AI :5000 has finished loading, then refresh the page.

Figure 5 · System Status. Wait until this looks healthy



IMPORTANT · You only need start.bat

You do not need to run docker compose for the whole application. If MongoDB is not installed as a Windows service, start.bat will try Docker for MongoDB only.

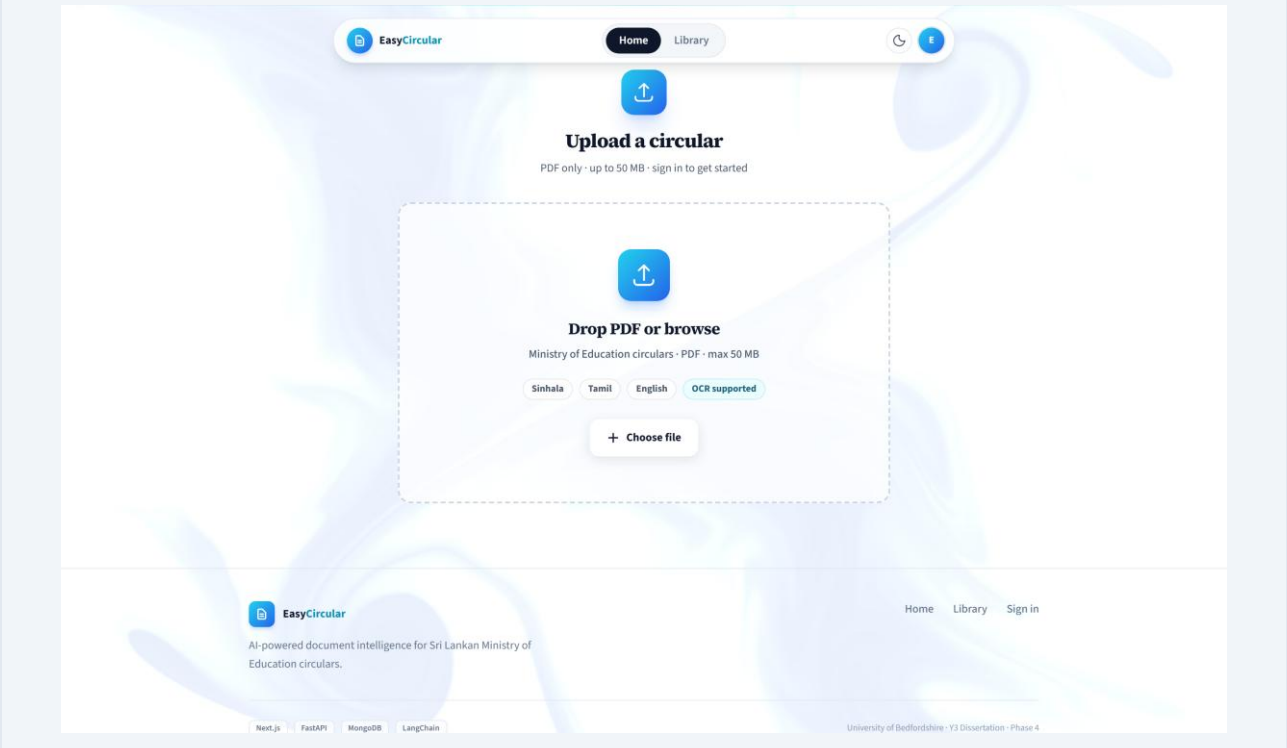
04 The usual path

Along the top of a document you will see four steps: Upload, Extract, Review, Summarize. That is the whole job, in order.

1	2	3	4
Upload	**Extract**	**Review**	**Summarize**
Sign in. Drop a PDF, or import one from the catalog.	Wait. Scanned pages take longer.	Fix the number and the dates. Then Text is correct.	Read the brief. Export it if you need a copy.

From home, Start Processing or New Analysis gets you a file in. Then: Editor, Save edits, Text is correct, Generate summary. The two things worth checking by hand are the circular number and the dates. Staff act on those.

Figure 6 · Signed in. The upload box is available



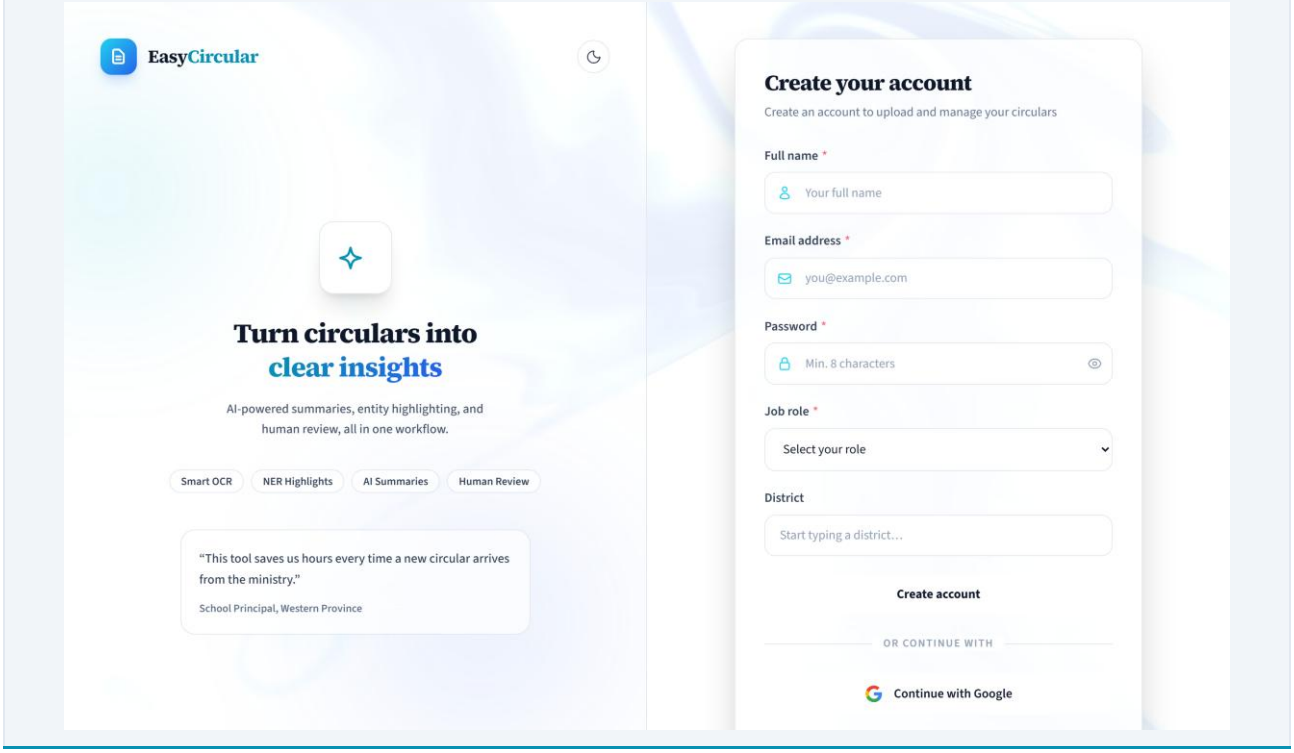
05 Accounts

New account

Click Get Started or Sign up. You will be asked for your name, email, a password of at least eight characters, and your job role (Teacher, Principal, or Education administration). District is optional; type a few letters and pick from the list.

Create account, or Continue with Google if that is easier. After that you land back at upload.

Figure 7 · Sign-up form

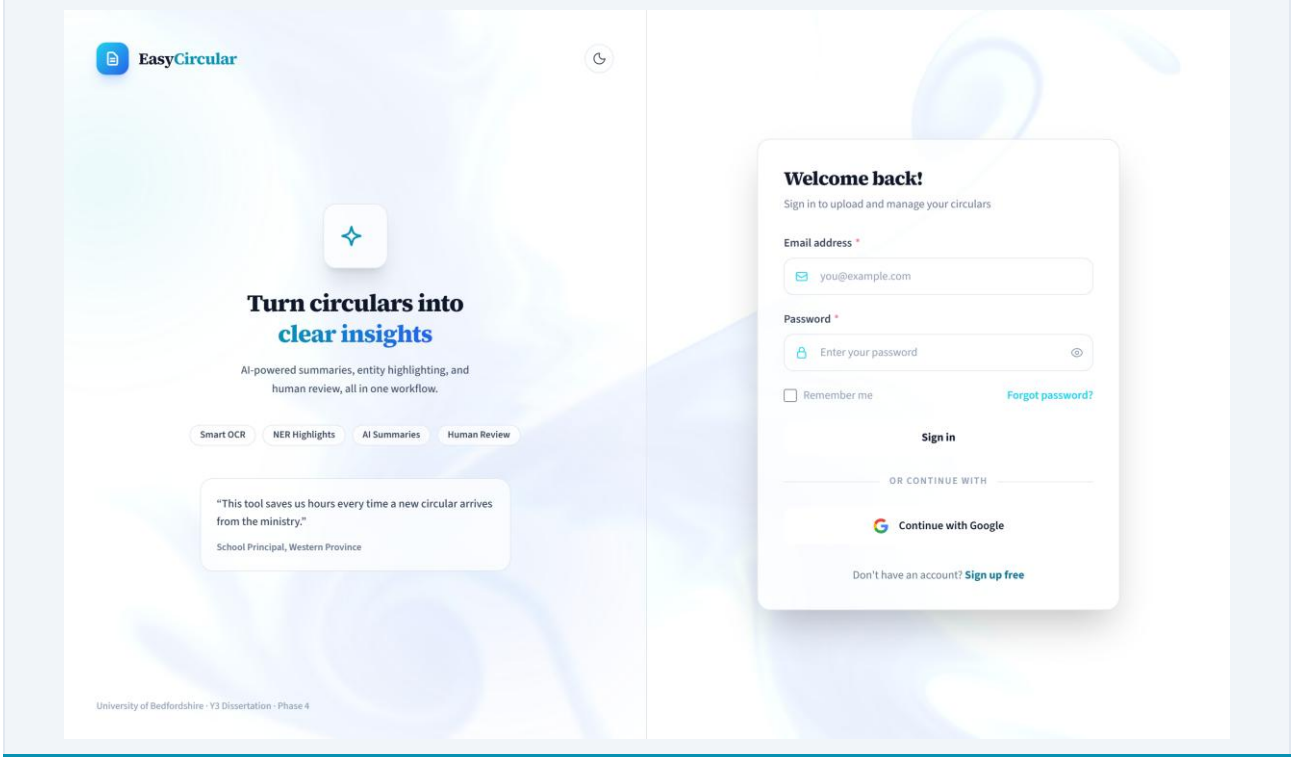


Coming back

Use Sign in. Same email and password, or Google again. Remember me is there if you want it.

> **NOTE · Forgot password?**
> The link is on the form. It does not actually reset anything yet. If you are stuck, try Google, or get someone to make a new account.

Figure 8 · Sign-in



Sign out is in the top bar on the home page, and in the left sidebar once you are in a document.

06 Home

This is the first screen. The dark Start Processing button takes you to upload (it will send you to sign in if you have not). Official circulars opens the moe.gov.lk list inside EasyCircular.

Get Started is sign in / sign up. The moon (or sun) icon switches dark mode. Library is your own files. The four cards under the fold are just a description of the product. You do not click them to do the work.

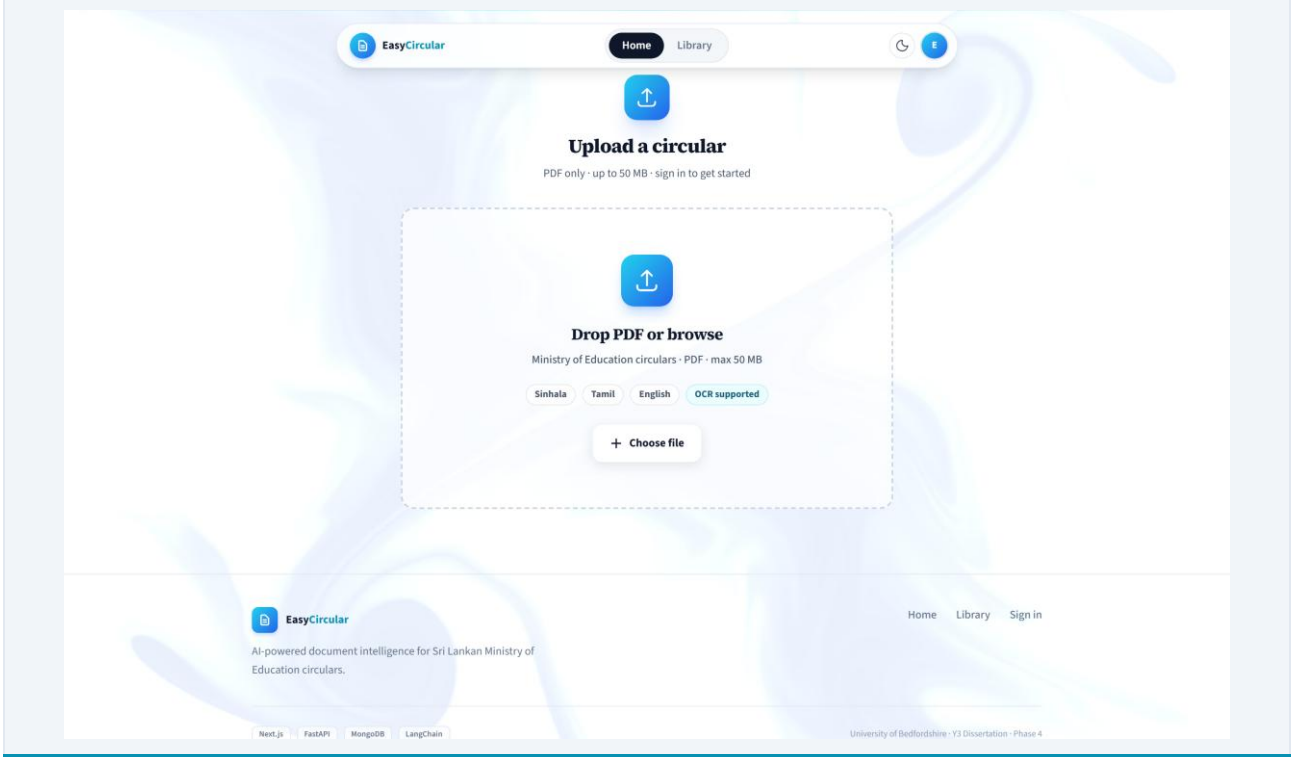
07 Uploading a PDF

If you are not signed in, the box says Sign in to upload. Fair enough.

From home, scroll down to the drop area, or once you are in the workspace use New Analysis on the left. Drop the file, or click to browse. You should see Uploading your circular…, then the document screen opens.

Limit	What happens
Has to be a PDF	Renaming a Word file to .pdf will not work
50 MB	Anything larger is rejected
One file at a time	There is no upload-this-whole-folder button

Figure 9 · The upload box on the home page



08 Checking the text

Extraction usually starts on its own. If it does not, use Extract text. Re-extract runs it again if the first pass looked empty or garbled. Sinhala and Tamil scans can sit there for a while. Leave the tab open.

You cannot generate a summary until you have said the text is all right. That is the Review step.

Open Source text. Editor is where you type. Highlights shows coloured tags later, after a summary exists.

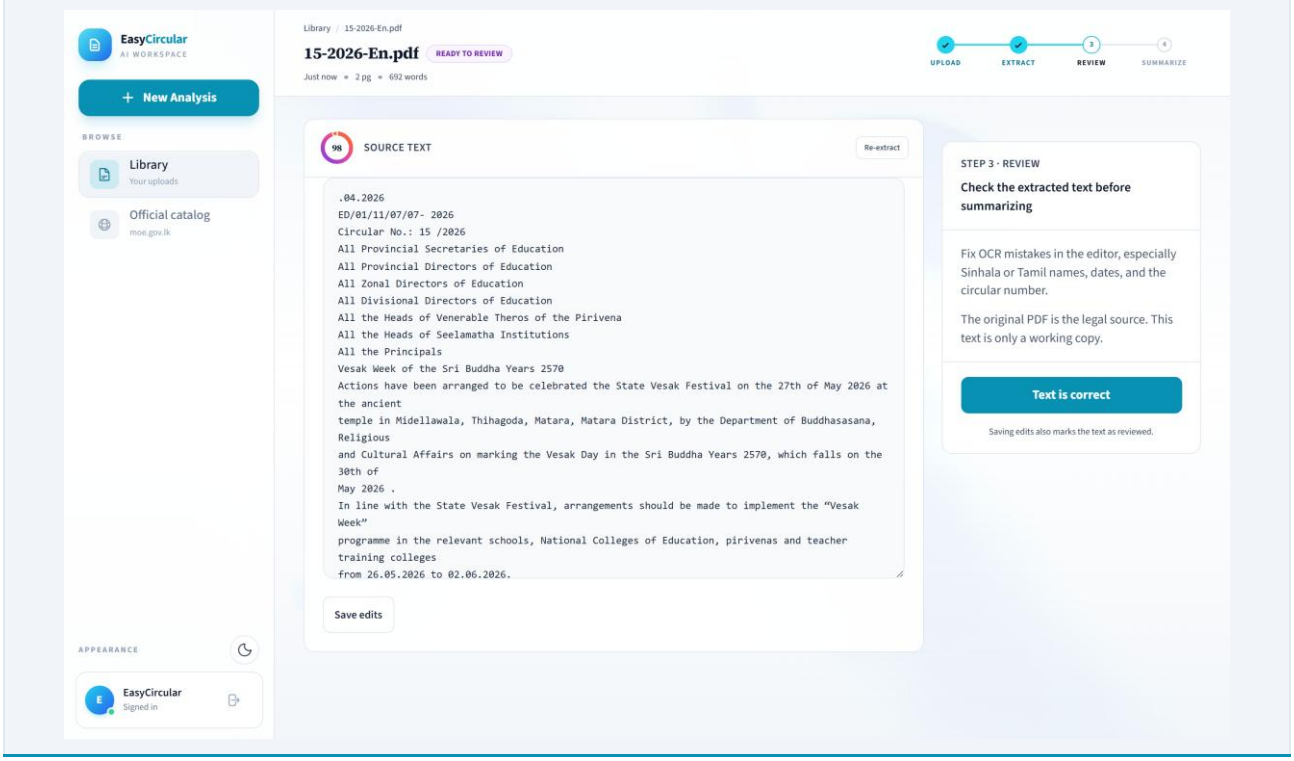
Correct the obvious stuff: circular number, dates, school names, anything OCR mangled in Sinhala or Tamil.

Save edits (that also counts as reviewed). Then Text is correct, then Generate summary.

IMPORTANT · Working copy

The text on screen is a working copy. The PDF is still the circular. Fix the number and the dates here before you trust the brief.

Figure 10 · Review. Read the text, then confirm it before you summarise.



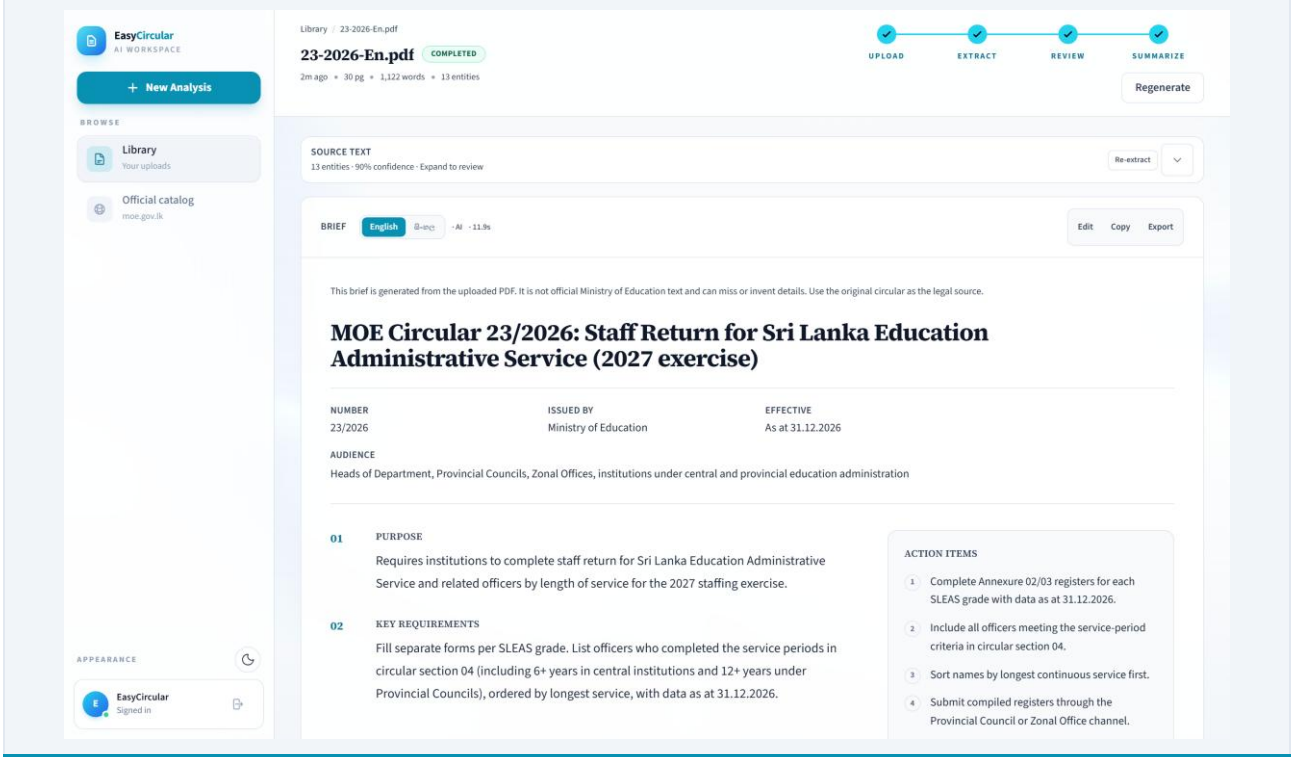
09 The summary

Generate summary shows Building brief… for a bit. What you get is a title, the number, who issued it, who it is for, when it takes effect, a purpose, the main requirements, Action items, and sometimes Key references.

Button	What it is for
Edit	Change the wording, then Save changes or Cancel. Original language only.
Copy	Puts it on the clipboard
Export	Downloads a PDF of the brief — not the original circular
Regenerate	Runs it again from the text you have now
Language tabs	English / සිංහල / தமிழ், depending on the source

There is a small disclaimer on every brief. Read it. The model can skip things or make things up. If the file came from the catalog, Open on moe.gov.lk is a link back to the ministry page. Use it.

Figure 11 · A finished brief. Action items are on the right.



When the summary is not quite right

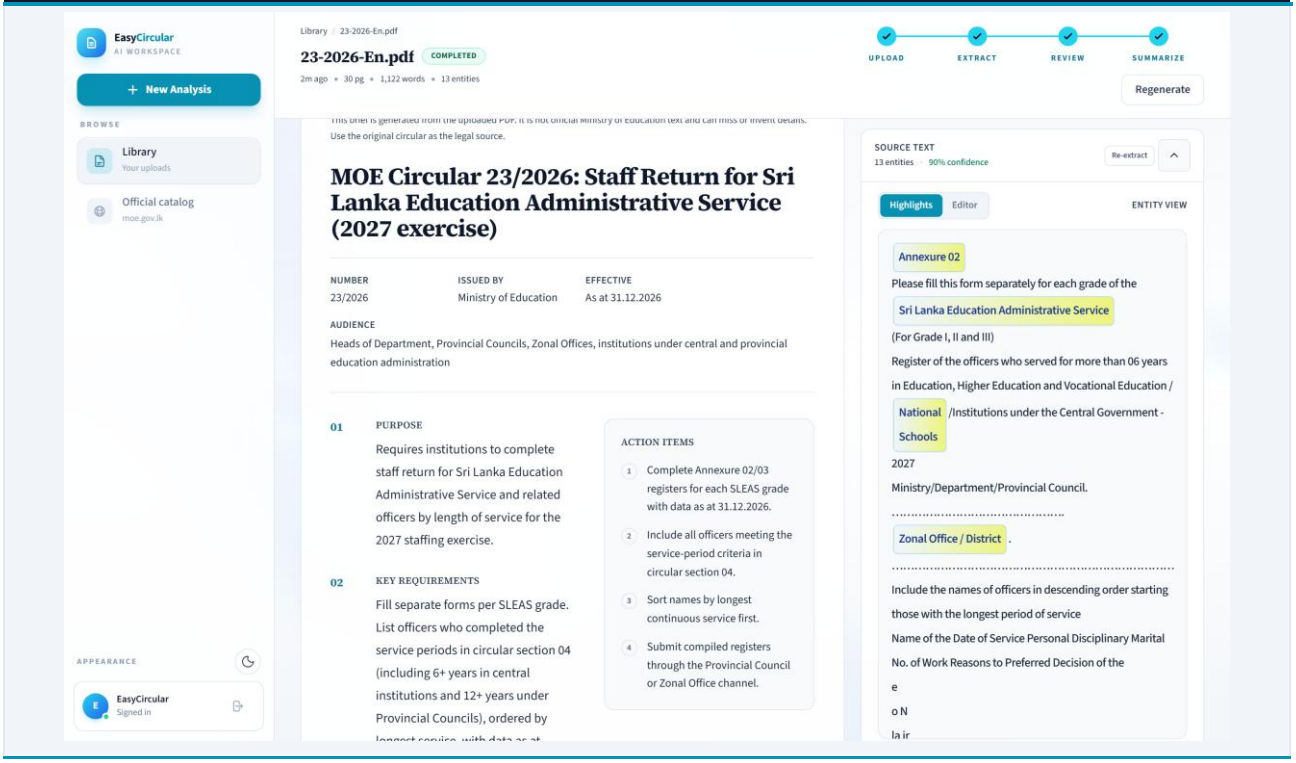
You will see	What happened	Sensible next step
AI summary unavailable	The model did not run. You get a plainer extract instead.	Try Regenerate in a few minutes.
Review suggested	It thought a date was invented, or two circulars got mixed.	Open the PDF. Do not act on the brief yet.
Unreadable brief	The text came out as a mix of scripts.	Regenerate.

10 Coloured labels in the text

After a summary, expand Source text and switch to Highlights. Dates, organisations, people, and legal-looking phrases are marked. You might see something like “13 entities · 90% confidence” on the bar. Treat that as a hint, not a score you report to anyone.

Colour	Tag	Usually
Yellow / amber	DATE	Deadlines and issue dates
Blue	ORG	Ministry, a school, a provincial office
Pink	PERSON	A name on the letter
Teal	LAW	Circular numbers, acts
Grey	OTHER	Anything else it tagged

Figure 12 · Highlights on the source text



11 Saving and translating

Export

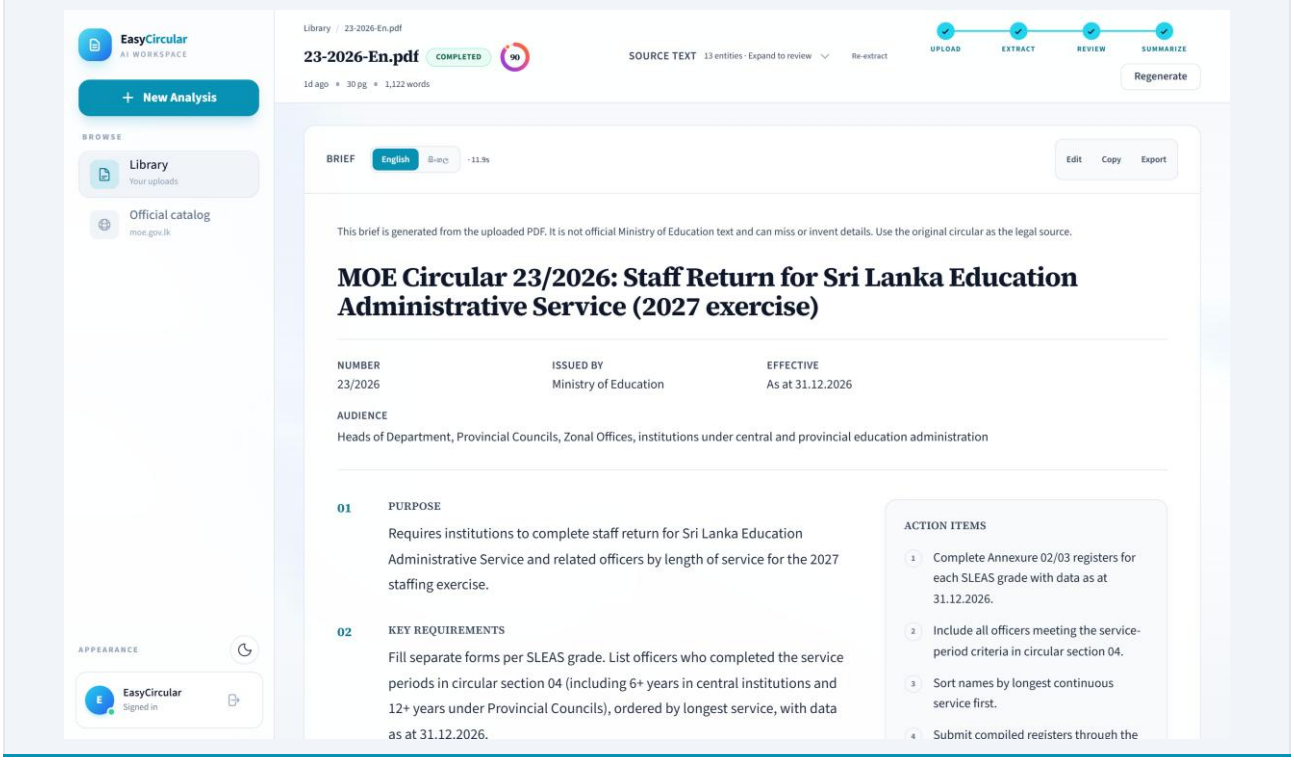
Export is on the brief toolbar. That PDF is the summary, for a staff meeting or an email. If you only need a paste, use Copy.

Translate

The language tabs are on the left of the same toolbar. English circulars usually offer Sinhala as well. A Sinhala or Tamil original will offer English. Click the tab and wait for Translating brief…

> **TIP · Translations**
>
> Handy for sharing with staff. Not more official than the circular you uploaded.

Figure 13 · Language tabs, Edit, Copy, Export



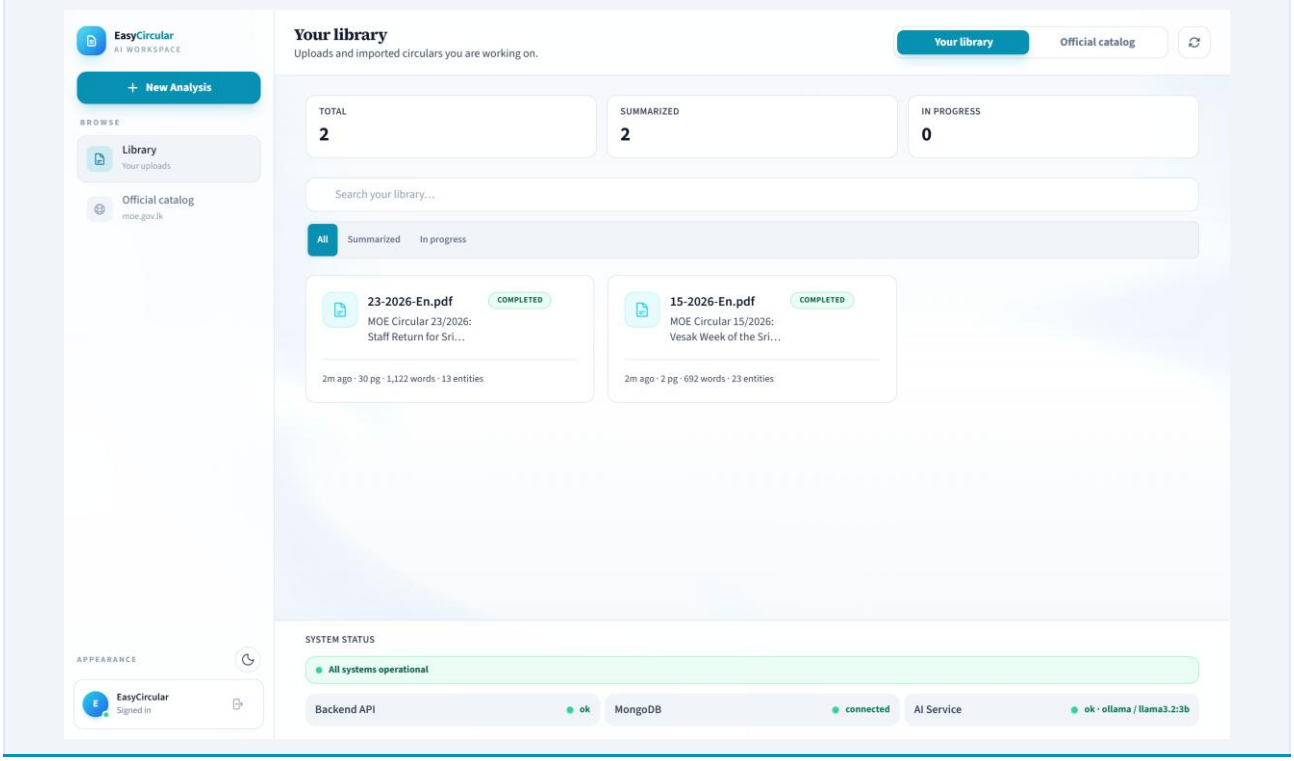
12 Library

Library in the sidebar (or from home) is your pile of work. Uploads and catalog imports both land here. The switch at the top is Your library versus Official catalog. On your library you can filter All, Summarized, or In progress, and you can search by file name or a bit of the summary.

Click a card to open it. Each card shows how old it is, pages, words, and how many tags it found. Imports from the ministry are marked Official moe.gov.lk. Delete is on the card. It asks once. After that the file is gone.

If you are not signed in you can still see the layout, but you will be asked to sign in before anything is saved against you.

Figure 14 · Library

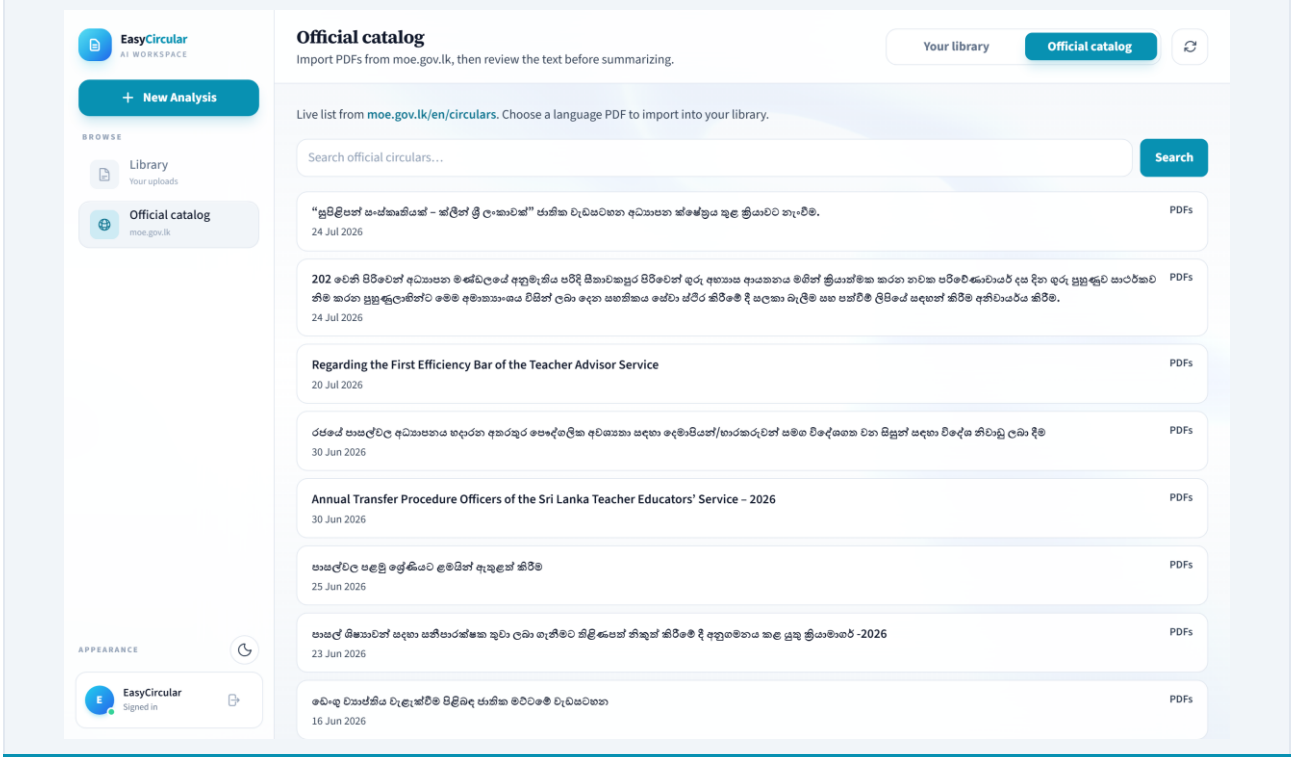


13 Official catalog

This is the list from moe.gov.lk, shown inside EasyCircular. Importing a PDF does not mean EasyCircular is the ministry. The summary is still made here, from that file.

Open Official catalog (home has Official circulars as well). Search. On an entry, open PDFs, then Import. If you are not signed in it will say Sign in to import. Importing… takes a moment. After that it is the same as an upload: extract, review, summarise. Previous and Next move through the list.

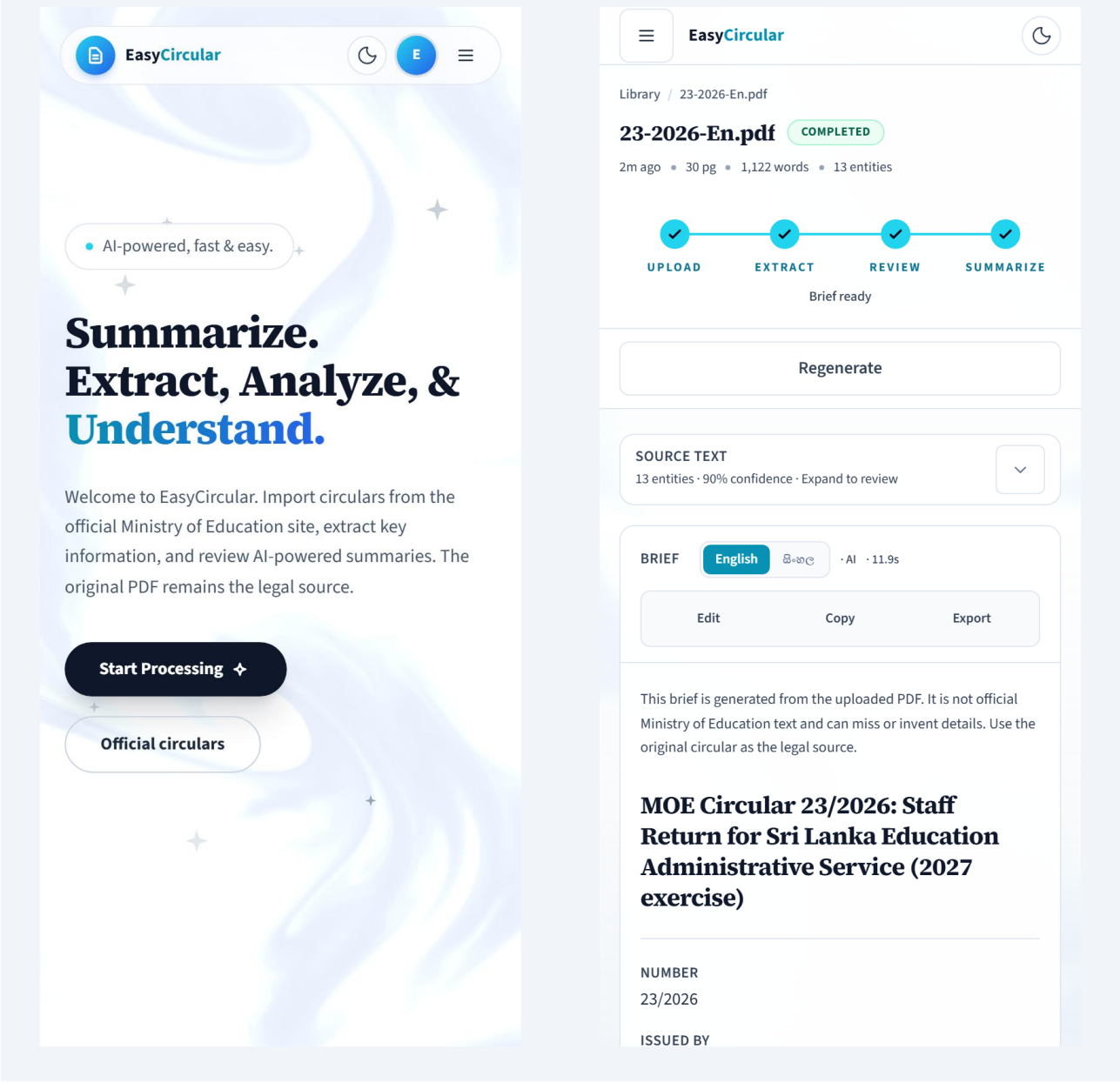
Figure 15 · Catalog search and import



14 On a phone

It works in the phone browser with the same login. Buttons stack. New Analysis is still how you upload. If you are going to sit and correct a long Sinhala scan, a laptop is less painful.

Figure 16 · Home on a phone **Figure 17 · A brief on a phone**



15 Those little status labels

Label	Colour	Meaning
Uploaded	Cyan	File is in. Text not out yet.
Ready to review	Purple	Text is there. You still have to check it.
Processing	Amber	Summary is running.
Completed	Green	Brief is ready.
Failed	Red	It broke. Try again or Retry.

16 When something goes wrong

Check the circular number and the dates first. If those are wrong, fix them in the editor and regenerate. Prefer Official catalog when you can, so you are not working from a photocopy someone emailed last year. Export once you are happy, and file that PDF with the original circular.

Problem	Try this
Sign in to upload	You are not logged in.
Cannot open http://localhost:3002	The Frontend :3002 window is closed, or start.bat has not finished yet.
AI unreachable / System Status not healthy	Wait for the AI :5000 window, then refresh the page.
start.bat stops with a red message	Install Node.js 20+, Python 3.11+, and MongoDB or Docker, then run start.bat again.
File rejected	It is not a real PDF, or it is over 50 MB.
Blank or messy text	Wait, then Re-extract. Edit what you can.
Summary is nonsense	Fix the source, Save edits, Regenerate.
AI summary unavailable	The model is down or busy. Try later.
Forgot password?	Does not work. Use Google, or a password you still know.
A long scan is slow	That is normal. Do not close the tab.

EasyCircular will not email the Ministry for you, will not file your staff return, and will not take a whole folder of PDFs in one go. If a date matters, read it in the original circular. The home page has a System Status strip. If that looks unhealthy, the summary may fail until someone brings the services back up.

When in doubt, open the PDF

This guide is for EasyCircular as it stands in August 2026. The System Status strip on the home page tells you if the site is actually up.